

Character Sketch of M Hamel and Franz from Class 12 English Flamingo Book

Chapter 1 The Last Lesson

The Last Lesson Overview – The importance of language and its connection with nationalism are the central themes of the chapter “The Last Lesson.” The protagonist of the narrative is a little kid, Franz, whose teacher, M Hamel is compelled to flee his native town in France’s Alsace region because German settlers are annexing it and making German its official language. Now the mother tongue, French will not longer be taught in the schools of French districts of Alsace and Lorraine. Even though it is obvious that his students won’t be able to speak French in the future, the narrator’s French teacher, Monsieur Hamel, is determined to give them one more lesson in the language. The teacher emphasizes that language is an integral element of one’s identity and culture and that its suppression constitutes an act of oppression, as done by the enemy country. The French villagers realize that they have been overpowered by the enemy soldiers because they did not value their country and their mother tongue

Character Sketch of Franz

Franz is a young boy who lives in a small town in Alsace district of France, which was annexed by Germany (then Prussia) in the Franco-Prussian war. Franz is a typical young boy who likes to play with his friends, go fishing in the river, and daydream. Although he is a talented student who is constantly eager to learn new things, he is not particularly interested in learning French. Franz is shown to be ignorant of the political tensions between France and Germany and to be naive. Knowing that the Germans are imposing their language on the region, he is horrified to find that this will be his final French session. Despite his initial disinterest, Franz eventually comes to appreciate the beauty and value of his mother tongue and has a profound feeling of loss as he witnesses its disappearance. He also develops a liking for the teacher M Hamel who he earlier despised. Now that they will not be taught French, Franz wants to learn it!!

chapter 2 lost spring

Saheb e Alam is a young boy who lives in the Seemapuri slum which is on the periphery of Delhi. His family is one of the squatters who came from Dhaka. According to the writer, Saheb would be in utter disbelief if he knew that the meaning of his name is ‘lord of the world’ which is ironic considering the conditions that he lives in. Saheb e Alam, like others who live in Seemapuri, is a ragpicker. He comes in the morning and disappears by afternoon along with a group of friends who roam around the streets barefooted. For Saheb e Alam ragpicking is a source of joy and mystery. This is because he sometimes finds a rupee in the pile of garbage and once you find that, there is always some hope to find more. He lives in a deprived condition in seemapuri where even the most basic amenities are unavailable. As a ragpicker Saheb was his own boss, a free man but, when he took up a job at the tea stall, he sacrificed his freedom.

The Lost Spring: Stories of Stolen Childhood Overview – The sad position of poor children who are forced to have a wretched life and forgo the fun times of childhood due to their social circumstances is the subject of the story “Lost Spring.” These children are compelled to labour from an early age and are not given the opportunity to pursue an education. Anees Jung, the writer, makes a concerted effort to end child labour. She advocates for government enforcement of strict laws prohibiting child work as well as enforce the education of children. She talks about her encounter with a slum dweller kid named Saheb-e-Alam who is a ragpicker and wishes to play tennis and go to a school. However, these wishes remain unfulfilled. Another boy named Mukesh hails from a family of bangle makers from Firozabad. Their lives are miserable because the profession does not provide a good livelihood and harms them physically too. The boy dreams to do something different but his dreams are restricted to the life that he has seen in his hometown. He aspires to become a car mechanic

Mukesh is a young boy who appears in the chapter “The Lost Spring” from Class 12 English textbook. He lives in Firozabad which is the hub of India’s glass blowing industry. The people of Firozabad are engaged in making bangles and so is Mukesh and his family. Mukesh lives in a small house which he proudly says is being renovated. It is situated in a small street which is filled with garbage and tightly packed houses. His family consists of his grandparents, his elder brother and his wife who is just a few years older than Mukesh. In a place like Firozabad people have accepted bangle making as their ‘karam’ and poverty, their fate. Nobody thinks of following a different path and the same is taught to their children. In such a place, Mukesh was courageous enough to dream of becoming a motor mechanic. He is determined to make this dream come true no matter what difficulty he faces. On being asked whether he would become a pilot, Mukesh shows a hint of embarrassment. His dream of becoming a motor mechanic might have arisen from the cars passing down the streets of the town but a plane would rarely fly over Firozabad

chapter 3 Deep Water Overview – This lesson is taken from William Douglas’ autobiographical book “Of Men and Mountains,” which deals with the subject of conquering fear. He talks about how he finally overcame his early phobia of the sea. The incident in the swimming pool where a bully nearly drowned him as a youngster and the infancy experience of being knocked down by the waves at the California beach contributed to a dread of water that haunted him even as an adult. He ultimately made the decision to face his anxiety because he was unable to enjoy swimming, fishing, or boating like others. His further attempts to get over the fear, demonstrate his guts and willpower. Therefore, the message being sent to us is that one must get above their fear.

William Douglas had a severe phobia of water. He was a young boy when he had an awful experience. At the age of five, he was pushed into the deep end and he almost drowned in a swimming pool. He was a shy, reserved individual who lacked confidence. Because of his fear, he was afraid of being teased, mocked, and denigrated by his classmates. His fear of the water often gets in the way of his confidence. He could not fulfil his desire of swimming in fresh water lakes. He made the decision to get over his phobia of water, and with the help of a swimming instructor, he started taking swimming classes. He practiced continuously until he mastered swimming because he was dedicated to his objective and was motivated to achieve it. Finally, he defeated the fear and realized that it only existed in his mind. The victory made him live a better and fulfilling life.

Chapter 4 The Rattrap Overview –

The potential of kindness and human connection to change even the most hardened and distrustful people is the central topic in Selma Lagerlof's "The Rattrap." The narrative chronicles the travels of an elderly vagrant who sells little rattraps. The tramp encounters several individuals along the way who, in spite of their own challenging situations, are kind and generous to him. The tramp reflects on his own life and actions as a result of this encounter, which finally inspires him to make amends and improve himself. The underlying message is that everyone is capable of change and that even the smallest act of kindness can have a big impact on someone else's life.

Character Sketch of Peddler

The peddler was a beggar who led a nomadic way of life. He was quite imaginative. He wore rags, had sunken cheeks, and his eyes gleamed from hunger. He roamed around the town selling wire rattraps that he made himself. He obtained this wire either through begging or by stealing. He possessed certain human flaws, such as the need to steal and beg to meet his basic necessities. He spent his evenings wherever he could find shelter because he had nowhere to stay during the day. He believes that the entire universe resembles a giant rat trap. It merely exists in order to attract others with bait. He believes that all wealth, happiness, food, clothing, and shelter are merely traps. The rattrap shuts on the person who touches the bait if and when he does.

Chapter 5 Indigo Overview – The chapter displays the importance of effective leadership in improving the lives of people. The author tells us a few reasons which made Mahatma Gandhiji famous and loved by the masses. He was concerned about the plight of the poor and fought for their rights. He also made efforts to uplift them and taught them self-reliance. The lesson gives us a message that leadership along with empathy are vital for someone to become a people's person.

Character Sketch of Gandhi Ji

The "Indigo" chapter recognizes Mahatma Gandhi's leadership in achieving justice for oppressed people through convincing argumentation and negotiation. Gandhiji is portrayed as a man of moral convictions who supported non-violent protests and nonviolent demonstrations. He is shown as someone who was willing to go to great lengths to achieve his goals and stood up for what he believed in. Gandhiji had a strong magnetic presence and persuasive powers. He had the ability to attract individuals from every level of society and turn them into allies in the freedom movement. It also emphasises his understanding of legal procedure and regard for the law. One gets to know about his humble lifestyle and rejection of materialism and luxury. He is a knowledgeable, kind, and determined person who is prepared to make significant sacrifices for the benefit of his nation and its people.

Character Sketch of Rajkumar Shukla

Raj Kumar Shukla was a poor, emaciated sharecropper in his mid-30s who had fallen victim to British landlords. Despite his illiteracy, he was adamant about upsetting the British landlords' unfairness. He is portrayed as a persistent, determined individual who is not easily deterred by challenges. He has few words but strong opinions. He uses simple expressions, yet his tone of voice as well as his actions show his sincerity and determination. In order to get Gandhiji's assistance in fighting the British landlords, he went to meet him. He stayed by Gandhiji's side until he gave him a time to visit Champaran. In the Champaran episode, Raj Kumar Shukla had a significant part to perform.

Chapter 6 Poets and Pancakes Overview – The chapter tells us about the different ways in which people work together despite having a dislike for each other. We also come to know the difference between reel life and real life. The narrator gives us an idea of the back stage happenings that took place at the Gemini studio, the relationship between the various artists, poets and other team members. The process for preparing the artists to perform in movie roles is also talked about.

Character Sketch of Ashokamitran

Ashokamitran was a prolific writer and a prominent figure in Tamil literature. He is presented as a shy, introverted individual who is devoted to his work in the Class 12 chapter "Poet and Pancakes." He takes an intense approach to writing, and this commitment to his profession is demonstrated by the meticulous revisions he makes until he is satisfied with what he produces. He is humble and reserved and prefers to blend into the background than stand out. While he is a man of few words, when he does, they are well-chosen and perceptive. He is able to relate to people deeply, and his work displays his comprehension of the human condition. He is a great observer of life, and the people and events he runs across in his daily life often serve as inspiration for his novels.

Character Sketch of Kothamangalam Subbu

Kothamangalam Subbu has been portrayed as a man whom everyone at Gemini Studios held in high esteem. He was born a Brahmin and perhaps due to this virtue, rose to the position of No. 2 at Gemini Studios. He had contacts with affluent people. He was cool, calm and composed and even a flop film, in which he was involved, never made him sad or unhappy. He looked cheerful all the time. He was very loyal to his boss and that endeared him to the boss. He was a man who could be inspired when commanded. He was creative and displayed this skill when effortlessly, he could give fourteen alternative ways to handle a particular scene. Subbu was a poet of calibre and had a separate identity as a poet. His success in films overshadowed his literacy achievements. He was an amazing actor yet never aspired to play lead roles. He loved everyone genuinely and selflessly. He was charitable and improvident. The author Asokamitran has portrayed him as an extremely talented, creative and lovable human being.

Character Sketch of Office Boy

The office boy was a forty year old makeup artist in Gemini studios, who was not satisfied with his present job as he wanted to become a successful director. He was jealous of Subbu, as he was closer to his boss. Due to his unsuccessful career, he had a tendency to criticize others. The office boy demonstrates the plight of those people who are not able to realise their dreams and spend their life in misery.

Character Sketch of Stephen Spender

Stephen Spender was a renowned British poet and intellectual, who played an important role in the literary and cultural scene of the 20th century. He was educated at Oxford University and became a part of the literary circle known as the "Auden Group," He was a prolific writer and wrote numerous poems, essays, and books throughout his career.

In the chapter "Poets and Pancakes," Spender is portrayed as a reserved and introspective individual who is deeply committed to his art. He is shown as being slightly aloof and detached from the other poets in the group, but also deeply thoughtful and introspective. He is

Character Sketch of Lawyer

The Lawyer in the chapter “Poets and the Pancakes” is shown as a cunning and opportunistic individual. He has a reputation for taking on issues that are morally dubious but could make him rich and famous. The lawyer is an assured and persuasive public speaker who is skilled at using the legal system to his advantage. He also demonstrates an ability to look for opportunities that might be used to his advantage. He has a reputation for being somewhat harsh and unsympathetic. As long as his clients can afford his fees, he is willing to represent those who have committed terrible acts of violence. Additionally, he appears unconcerned about utilising his legal expertise to take advantage of others or to get ahead in his career.

Chapter 8 Going Places Overview – The short story “Going Places” explores the hopes and desires of young people as well as the anguish of broken dreams and unfulfilled promises. Along with the teenage fantasising and hero-worship, it deals with the intricacies of human relationships. This story’s central theme is hero worship and teenage fantasies. Teenagers often have irrational expectations, especially if their families are struggling. This is due to the fact that a young person’s socioeconomic background has a significant impact on the job they choose to pursue. If the fantasy is too far fetched for a person, it might result in misery. We see the main character as building castles in the air which is a pointless activity.

Character Sketch of Sophie

Sophie is an escapist. She is a romantic dreamer who has very high aspirations. As seen at the start of the story, she ignores her reality of working in the biscuit factory and instead, aspires to become something a bit sophisticated. Her choices are manager, actress, and fashion designer. She has not seen the world but tries to get a glimpse of it from Geoff. Sometimes she wishes that he would take her out with him as she was ready for the vast world. Sophie liked to daydream about Danny Casey. She could not draw the fine line between reality and dreams. She believed her own fantasies to be true and waited for Danny at the park. When she realised that he would not come, she turned disappointed and felt a burden. These imaginary expectations that she creates in her mind cause her sadness

Character Sketch of Jansie

Jansie has been portrayed as the frame character in the story ‘Going places’ written by A. R Barton. Sophie and Jansie are both from working class, and their families appear to be friends with one another. Jansie has been Characterised as a realistic. Jansie is a friend of Sophie’s. Jansie is considerably more realistic and pessimistic than Sophie. She is also noted as a gossipmonger who is unable to keep secrets. She knows that the two of them are “earmarked for the biscuit factory” a truth which makes her feel “melancholy”.

Character Sketch of Danny Casey

Danny Casey is a famous football star who is greatly admired, most importantly by Sophie’s older brother Geoff. He is described as a young, bright, beloved “prodigy.” Sophie tells her family a story that she met Danny Casey and he asked her on a date, which is meant to impress them and make them admire her. However, she seems to believe her own fantasy, and is disappointed when Danny Casey doesn’t appear on the night she said they would meet. The version of Danny Casey that Sophie creates is gentle, has soft eyes, and is kind towards her. She says that Casey plans to open a boutique (which is also Sophie’s ambition), and she describes Casey as being her own height and “no bolder” than her. Clearly, then, the Danny Casey of Sophie’s fantasy is meant as a stand-in for her, someone living Sophie’s own dreams of success and acclaim who she imagines to be not meaningfully different from her (thereby making her own dreams seem more in reach).

Character Sketch of Sophie’s Brother Geoff

Geoff is Sophie’s older brother, the oldest child in the family. He is a mechanic apprentice who has a motorcycle, and (to Sophie, at least) this appears to give him freedom and a glamorous life. Sophie imagines that Geoff knows interesting people and travels to unknown parts of the city, and she hopes that he will take her with him, helping her to escape her own life. However, the story presents details about Geoff that suggest that Sophie is projecting onto him: he is shy, for instance, so it’s unlikely that he has lots of secret friends, and he spends a lot of time at home. He does not share Sophie’s interest in aesthetics, fame, or fortune, and while Sophie imagines Geoff in stylish clothes, in real life his clothes are unfashionable. Geoff’s main interest seems to be the football player Danny Casey, which leads Sophie to claim that she is going on a date with him. She hopes that this will make Geoff admire her, and while it does pique his interest, the scheme ultimately fails. Presumably, she and Geoff will not get closer and he will not rescue her from her life, since Geoff seems not to be the person Sophie hopes that he is.

Character Sketch of Sophie’s Father

Sophie’s father, who is not named, is the story’s antagonist. He works in some kind of manual labor, returning home each night dirty and sweaty and shovels food into his mouth. He treats Sophie with disdain, chastising her for telling “wild stories” and dismissing her ambitions and desires. Through the reactions of his children (who all seem scared of him), the reader learns that he is an imposing figure with a drinking problem and a temper. Barton describes him in a rather unfavorable way, using words such as “grimy” and pointing out the fat rolls on his neck.

Character Sketch of Sophie’s Mother

Sophie’s mom is a pleasant and hardworking woman, who shares none of her daughter’s interest in fashion and football. She comes from a middle-class family and has worked hard to improve her financial situation. She believes that success is measured by one’s wealth and social status and is very focused on ensuring that Sophie and her brother achieve this. She does not believe in taking risks or pursuing dreams that are not practical.

